Pariser Platz with the Brandenburg Gate illuminated behind the rejoined crowd, hovering as an icon and remainder.



FIGURE 5.1 Leonard Freed, *Berlin, 1989/1990*. (Estate of Leonard Freed/Magnum Photos)

After Freed's first trip to a reunified Berlin in 1989, he realized he wanted to follow up on his earlier Germany-focused projects, to weigh the unified "New Germany." He aimed to juxtapose contemporary images with others pulled from his own archive, many accompanied by diary-style annotations in which he pondered the past of Germany and of his career, in first-person prose through the window of his present. Freed faxed a letter to German curator Ute Eskildsen of the prestigious Folkwang Museum in 1990 at the onset of this project, outlining his aims:

> THE INTENTION IS TO FOLLOW UP ON MY 1970 BOOK WITH A SECOND, TO DEVELOPE [*sic*] AND EXTEND MY EXPERIENCES AS I HAVE BEEN DOING IN BOTH EAST AND WEST GERMANY OVER THE YEARS SINCE ITS PUBLICATION. … I FEEL BEING BORN IN THE UNITED STATES GIVES ME A FRESH OR EXTRA